

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

SOP-IT-001 — Secure Document Processing

Document Owner	Operations & IT Department
Version	1.0
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Review Frequency	Annual
Classification	INTERNAL
Status	Approved for Testing

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure defines the process for securely receiving, validating, processing, storing, and reviewing operational documents within the organization's internal environment.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to employees and administrators who upload or process business documents, including PDF files, scanned documents, images, and text-based documents using the internal document-processing system.

3. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Upload authorized documents and verify extracted information.
Administrator	Manage document access, review processing status, and handle failures.
System	Process documents locally and maintain processing logs.

4. Procedure

- **Step 1 — Document Submission:** Upload the authorized PDF, image, or text document through the internal application.
- **Step 2 — File Validation:** The system checks file type, size, readability, and basic document integrity.
- **Step 3 — Text Detection:** The system determines whether the document contains machine-readable text.
- **Step 4 — OCR Processing:** For scanned or image-based documents, OCR is performed locally using the configured OCR engine.
- **Step 5 — Verification:** Review extracted text and identify unreadable or low-confidence sections.
- **Step 6 — Storage:** Store the source document, extracted text, metadata, and processing status in the approved internal storage.
- **Step 7 — Audit:** Record the processing event, timestamp, user, and final status in the audit log.

5. Security Requirements

- Documents must remain within the organization's approved infrastructure.
- External cloud OCR services must not be used for confidential documents.
- OCR model files required for offline operation must be pre-cached locally.

- Access to uploaded documents must follow role-based access controls.
- Processing failures must be reported accurately and must not be marked as successful.

6. Exception Handling

If the OCR runtime or required model files are unavailable, the system must mark the operation as OCR_UNAVAILABLE or OCR_FAILED, preserve the original document, and provide an actionable error message. The system must not silently send the document to an external service.

7. Approval

Prepared By	Sovereign-X Test Environment
Reviewed By	System Administrator
Approval Status	TEST DOCUMENT — NOT FOR PRODUCTION USE